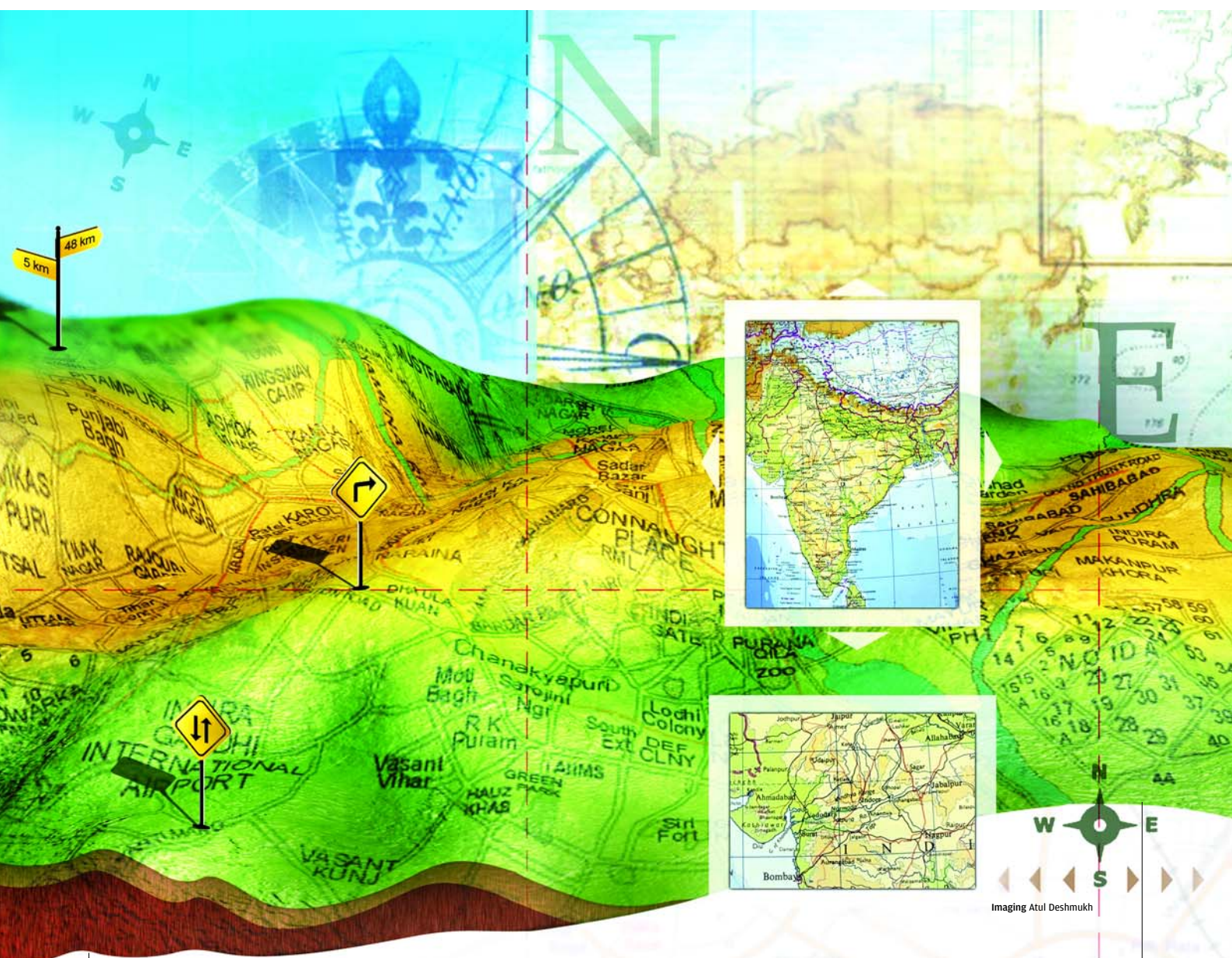




'How Do I Get There?'

This question could well be redundant, thanks to 19-year-old Rohan Verma's MapMyIndia.com

Meera Vankipuram

The geographically challenged amongst us have yet another reason to cheer. Nineteen-year-old Rohan Verma from New Delhi has helped create a Web site that has digitally mapped several cities in India.

MapMyIndia.com, one of the largest map and digital information databases in India, helps you access the map of a particular city, town or village at the click of a mouse. Just type in the name of the state, city and area and bingo, you get a detailed map.

You can choose to zoom in or out further, or even pan across the map to look for a specific area. City maps have a greater resolution, and can be zoomed in to the street level. Maps of rural areas have not yet been charted in such detail.

Cities in the level 1 to 4 segment have maximum detail, and you can choose to plot on the map anything from holy sites to railway stations, and hotels, shopping centres, historical landmarks, hospitals, and even the nearest ATMs.

Digitising India

Created with the help of satellite images and geographical surveys, digital maps resemble photographs with information mapped in the form of points—each point has a specific colour, representing land, water bodies, roads, etc. Digital maps are also accompanied by databases of relevant information—a list of popular tourist spots, for example.

Intended to be an Indian version of popular international ventures such as Yahoo! Maps and Mapquest, MapMyIndia was an idea born during Verma's summer internship with